

Q When will my baby arrive? Can I find out before I see my doctor?

It is easy to calculate the estimated birth date of your baby as long as you know the first day of your last menstrual period.

Before your first ultrasound, your doctor will use the first day of your last menstrual period (known as LMP) as a marker for the start of your pregnancy. This means you can calculate the estimated date of delivery (EDD) yourself using a due-date calendar, such as the one below. It is wonderful to have an actual day to work toward, but try not to get too

tied to it since the due date is only an estimate after all. Almost 50 percent of babies are born before the EDD and about the same again are born after the EDD. You will reach full term at 37 weeks and if you haven't given birth by 41 weeks you will be offered an induction to reduce the risk of having an overdue baby.

4%
of babies are born
on their **due date**.

WHEN WILL YOUR BABY BE BORN?

To figure out your estimated date of delivery (EDD)—also known as the due date—find the date you started your last menstrual period (LMP) on the upper lines of the chart, then see the dates in bold below to discover when your baby is expected. For example, if your last LMP was August 16, then your baby will be due on May 23.

JANUARY OCT/NOV	1 8	2 9	3 10	4 11	5 12	6 13	7 14	8 15	9 16	10 17	11 18	12 19	13 20	14 21	15 22	16 23	17 24	18 25	19 26	20 27	21 28	22 29	23 30	24 31	25 1	26 2	27 3	28 4	29 5	30 6	31 7
FEBRUARY NOV/DEC	1 8	2 9	3 10	4 11	5 12	6 13	7 14	8 15	9 16	10 17	11 18	12 19	13 20	14 21	15 22	16 23	17 24	18 25	19 26	20 27	21 28	22 29	23 30	24 1	25 2	26 3	27 4	28 5			
MARCH DEC/JAN	1 6	2 7	3 8	4 9	5 10	6 11	7 12	8 13	9 14	10 15	11 16	12 17	13 18	14 19	15 20	16 21	17 22	18 23	19 24	20 25	21 26	22 27	23 28	24 29	25 30	26 31	27 1	28 2	29 3	30 4	31 5
APRIL JAN/FEB	1 6	2 7	3 8	4 9	5 10	6 11	7 12	8 13	9 14	10 15	11 16	12 17	13 18	14 19	15 20	16 21	17 22	18 23	19 24	20 25	21 26	22 27	23 28	24 29	25 30	26 31	27 1	28 2	29 3	30 4	
MAY FEB/MAR	1 5	2 6	3 7	4 8	5 9	6 10	7 11	8 12	9 13	10 14	11 15	12 16	13 17	14 18	15 19	16 20	17 21	18 22	19 23	20 24	21 25	22 26	23 27	24 28	25 1	26 2	27 3	28 4	29 5	30 6	31 7
JUNE MAR/APR	1 8	2 9	3 10	4 11	5 12	6 13	7 14	8 15	9 16	10 17	11 18	12 19	13 20	14 21	15 22	16 23	17 24	18 25	19 26	20 27	21 28	22 29	23 30	24 31	25 1	26 2	27 3	28 4	29 5	30 6	
JULY APR/MAY	1 7	2 8	3 9	4 10	5 11	6 12	7 13	8 14	9 15	10 16	11 17	12 18	13 19	14 20	15 21	16 22	17 23	18 24	19 25	20 26	21 27	22 28	23 29	24 30	25 1	26 2	27 3	28 4	29 5	30 6	31 7
AUGUST MAY/JUNE	1 8	2 9	3 10	4 11	5 12	6 13	7 14	8 15	9 16	10 17	11 18	12 19	13 20	14 21	15 22	16 23	17 24	18 25	19 26	20 27	21 28	22 29	23 30	24 31	25 1	26 2	27 3	28 4	29 5	30 6	31 7
SEPTEMBER JUNE/JULY	1 8	2 9	3 10	4 11	5 12	6 13	7 14	8 15	9 16	10 17	11 18	12 19	13 20	14 21	15 22	16 23	17 24	18 25	19 26	20 27	21 28	22 29	23 30	24 1	25 2	26 3	27 4	28 5	29 6	30 7	
OCTOBER JULY/AUG	1 8	2 9	3 10	4 11	5 12	6 13	7 14	8 15	9 16	10 17	11 18	12 19	13 20	14 21	15 22	16 23	17 24	18 25	19 26	20 27	21 28	22 29	23 30	24 31	25 1	26 2	27 3	28 4	29 5	30 6	31 7
NOVEMBER AUG/SEPT	1 8	2 9	3 10	4 11	5 12	6 13	7 14	8 15	9 16	10 17	11 18	12 19	13 20	14 21	15 22	16 23	17 24	18 25	19 26	20 27	21 28	22 29	23 30	24 31	25 1	26 2	27 3	28 4	29 5	30 6	
DECEMBER SEPT/OCT	1 7	2 8	3 9	4 10	5 11	6 12	7 13	8 14	9 15	10 16	11 17	12 18	13 19	14 20	15 21	16 22	17 23	18 24	19 25	20 26	21 27	22 28	23 29	24 30	25 1	26 2	27 3	28 4	29 5	30 6	31 7

Q How can I find out my stage of pregnancy?

You will have your first ultrasound, also known as a dating scan, at around 8–14 weeks. The due date is based on your last menstrual period, but does not tell you when you conceived. Ultrasounds are a more accurate indicator of your stage of pregnancy and due date. You may find you are further along than you thought.

Q Is it important to know which trimester I'm in?

It helps to understand the trimesters, so you know what to expect at each stage. The first trimester lasts from the first day of your last period to 12 weeks pregnant (you conceive at two weeks). During this trimester you may experience a lot of symptoms (see opposite). It can also be an anxious time because the risk of

miscarriage is highest in the first trimester. In the second trimester—from 13 weeks to 25 weeks pregnant—you may have fewer symptoms, but will probably feel more pregnant because you will start to show. The final trimester, up to 42 weeks, can be very tiring, due to the weight of the baby, interrupted sleep, and symptoms such as backaches. While this can be a tough stage, it is exciting too since you begin all the preparation for your baby's arrival.